

KEEPING IT REAL

MORTGAGE PAYMENTS DOUBLED IN FIVE YEARS.

Zillow's chief economist says buyers still have leverage. Here's where it is.

D.J. Paris
Keeping It Real Podcast

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"DON'T GET TOO HUNG UP ON WHERE RATES ARE."

Mischa Fisher, Zillow's chief economist, says the math still works for buyers who move now.

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THE PAYMENT IS REAL. SO IS THE LEVERAGE.

The typical cost of a mortgage payment has doubled in the last five years, while incomes are only up by a third, Zillow's chief economist Mischa Fisher said on Keeping It Real. But the rate isn't the only number that moved. Inventory has climbed for 30-plus straight months, the longest stretch in years. More homes on the market means buyers can finally negotiate the repairs and contingencies they used to just accept.

WHAT TO DO WITH YOUR NEXT RATE-SHY BUYER:

1 **Say the real math out loud.**
Show the exact monthly number and what it buys, instead of letting the rate alone scare them off.

2 **Point to the inventory streak.**
Thirty-plus straight months of rising supply means buyers have more to choose from than they have in years.

3 **Negotiate what used to be fixed.**
Repairs, contingencies, and closing costs are back on the table.

4 **Check one Zillow number a month.**
Fisher's own pick: the change in home values, at zillow.com/research.



THE TAKEAWAY

THE PAYMENT DOUBLED. THE LEVERAGE DID TOO.

Use both the next time a buyer says they're waiting for rates to drop.

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